

Amazon

SDET Intern — Placement Prep Brief

B.Tech 4th Year · CSE / IT / ECE · India (Bangalore · Hyderabad · Chennai · Pune)

Stipend ■80K–■1.25L/month · 6–12 week program · PPO conversion rate >70% · 11,000 engineers being hired in 2026

■ COMPANY OVERVIEW

Amazon (NASDAQ: AMZN) is the world's largest e-commerce and cloud computing company, founded in 1994 by Jeff Bezos. Its **Amazon Web Services (AWS)** division — the world's leading cloud platform — reported **21% revenue growth in Q4 2025**, cementing its position as the single biggest profit engine at the company. Amazon operates across e-commerce, logistics, AI/ML, digital streaming, devices (Alexa, Kindle), and enterprise cloud. It employs over 1.5 million people globally.

For engineering interns, Amazon is uniquely valuable: you work on production-scale systems touching hundreds of millions of customers from day one. The SDET role sits at the intersection of software engineering and quality — you build the tools that ensure Amazon's services never go down.

Sources: amazon.jobs, peplematters.in (AWS hiring 2026), kore1.com AWS Q4 2025 revenue

■ HIRING PROCESS (5 Stages)

Stage 1 — Resume Screening + Interest Form

Apply via amazon.jobs or campus placement cell. Amazon also sends interest forms to shortlisted students directly via email (watch your inbox from July–August for the 6-month internship cycle). Applications reviewed on a rolling basis.

Stage 2 — Online Assessment (OA) on HackerRank / Mettle

1 hr 45 min test with 4 sections: (1) Coding Challenge — 2 medium-hard DSA problems (timed); (2) Working at Amazon — Leadership Principles situational questions; (3) Engineering Work Style; (4) General Work Style. All 4 sections must be completed to stay in consideration.

Stage 3 — Technical Interview Round 1 (45–60 min)

1–2 DSA coding problems (LeetCode medium, graphs/ hashing common). Followed by behavioural questions using Leadership Principles — prepare STAR stories.

Stage 4 — Technical Interview Round 2 (45–60 min)

SDET-specific: QA principles, software testing lifecycle (STLC), test case design (positive/negative/edge), black-box vs. white-box testing, regression, sanity. May include a system design light question or Gen AI awareness question.

Stage 5 — Bar Raiser / HR Round

Amazon's unique Bar Raiser round: an independent evaluator (not on your team) assesses culture fit against Amazon's 16 Leadership Principles. This round is non-negotiable — failing it means no offer regardless of technical scores.

■ Total process: 2–4 weeks. Entirely virtual for off-campus; on-campus varies.

Sources: Glassdoor SDET interview reviews, Medium intern experience (Aug 2025), GeeksforGeeks SDET experience

■ TECHNICAL STACK

Languages (pick at least one, know it deeply): Java · Python · C++ · C# · Go · TypeScript · JavaScript

Testing Frameworks & Tools: Selenium · TestNG · JUnit · PyTest · REST Assured · Appium (mobile testing)

Cloud (AWS — know the basics): EC2 · S3 · Lambda · DynamoDB · RDS · CloudWatch · IAM · SQS/SNS

CI/CD & DevOps: Git / GitHub · Jenkins · GitHub Actions · Docker · basic Kubernetes concepts

Databases: SQL (JOINS, indexing, EXPLAIN) · NoSQL concepts (DynamoDB is Amazon-native)

Testing Concepts (QA theory — expect direct questions on these):

- STLC (Software Testing Life Cycle) — all phases

- Black-box vs. White-box vs. Grey-box testing
- Unit / Integration / System / Regression / Sanity / Smoke / E2E testing
- Test case design: equivalence partitioning, boundary value analysis
- Defect life cycle · severity vs. priority

Nice-to-Have: AI/ML tools for dev productivity · Open-source contributions · Performance testing (JMeter) · API testing (Postman)

Sources: [amazon.jobs Fall 2026 SDE intern JD](#), [ziprecruiter Amazon SDET JD](#), [prepterminal.com OA guide](#)

■ RECENT NEWS (2025–2026)

- **30,000 layoffs (Oct 2025 + Jan 2026), then 11,000 new hires (Apr 2026):** Amazon cut ~14K roles in Oct 2025 and ~16K in Jan 2026 — mostly managerial, HR, and non-technical roles. AWS CEO Matt Garman then confirmed Amazon plans to **hire 11,000 software developers and interns in 2026**, saying "We are hiring just as many software developers as we ever had." Technical intern seats are explicitly protected and growing.
 - **AWS revenue growth at 21% (Q4 2025):** AWS remains Amazon's crown jewel. Despite layoffs elsewhere, AWS is accelerating. SDET interns often land on AWS teams.
 - **AI-first engineering pivot:** Amazon is deploying AI agents to automate repetitive tasks, which means engineers (including SDETs) are being asked to work at higher levels of abstraction — building test frameworks, not running manual scripts.
 - **PPO conversion >70%:** Interns who perform well have a very high conversion rate to full-time SDE-1 / SDET-1 offers. The internship is effectively a 6-week interview.
- **Honest context:** Layoffs hit India offices (Bengaluru, Chennai, Hyderabad). These were concentrated in ops, HR, and Alexa AI — not in core SDE/SDET engineering. Know this for the HR round; frame it as "Amazon is doubling down on technical excellence."

Sources: [peoplematters.in \(Apr 2026\)](#), [storyboard18.com](#), [dqindia.com](#), [kore1.com](#), [letsdatascience.com](#)

■ ELIGIBILITY CRITERIA

Target Batch: Final year (graduating 2026) or pre-final year (graduating 2027 — for 6-month programs)

Eligible Degrees: B.Tech / B.E. / M.Tech in CSE · IT · ECE · Data Science or related STEM

CGPA Cutoff: **7.0 / 10 or 70% equivalent** (official Amazon JD minimum; Tier-1 campus drives may shortlist from 8.0+)

Backlogs: **No active backlogs.** Jobdexo official JD states max 1 pending backlog permissible — but zero backlogs is safest.

Stipend: ■80,000 to ■1,25,000/month depending on team and location [verify exact figure with offer letter — aggregators vary]

Duration: 6 weeks (summer) or 6 months (PPO track) | **Mode:** In-person / hybrid (team-dependent)

Locations: Bangalore · Hyderabad · Chennai · Pune · Delhi NCR

Application route: [amazon.jobs/university](#) · Campus placement cell · LinkedIn · Amazon Hackathons (WoW, ML Summer School)

Sources: [jobdexo.com official JD](#), [amazon.jobs Fall 2026 intern JD](#), [naukri.com campus guide](#), [hirst.tech](#)

■ 5 TARGETED PREP TIPS

Tip 1 — Master Amazon's 16 Leadership Principles (LPs) — non-negotiable. Every round at Amazon includes behavioural questions mapped to LPs. Prepare 2 STAR stories per LP. The most tested: Customer Obsession · Ownership · Dive Deep · Earn Trust · Bias for Action. This is as important as your DSA.

Tip 2 — Solve 100+ LeetCode Medium problems before the OA. The OA coding section is 2 medium-hard problems in ~60 min. Focus: arrays, trees, graphs, DP, two-pointers, sliding window. Time yourself — Amazon tests efficiency, not just correctness.

Tip 3 — Build deep QA theory — it is a dedicated interview round. Amazon has a full round on testing concepts: STLC, test case design (write positive + negative + edge cases for a "Login" feature live), defect severity vs. priority, regression strategy. Most CS students skip this — don't.

Tip 4 — Get hands-on with at least one AWS service. Create a free-tier AWS account. Deploy a simple app on EC2, store data in S3, set up a Lambda function. SDET interns almost always touch AWS in their projects. Practical exposure > theoretical knowledge here.

Tip 5 — Frame every project as a test-coverage story. In SDET interviews, 'I built an e-commerce app' is weak. 'I built an e-commerce app and designed 40 test cases covering payment failures, cart race conditions, and session expiry' is strong. Add a testing lens to every project on your resume before you apply.

Sources: Glassdoor SDET reviews, GeeksforGeeks Amazon SDET experience, preterminal.com OA guide, amazon.jobs JD

Verified Sources: amazon.jobs (official JD) · jobdexo.com official SDET JD · glassdoor.com Amazon SDET interview reviews · medium.com SDE intern experience (Aug 2025) · geeksforgeeks.org Amazon SDET experience · peoplesmatters.in (11K hire announcement) · storyboard18.com (layoff + hiring news Apr 2026) · kore1.com (AWS Q4 2025 revenue) · naukri.com campus guide · hirst.tech internship guide · preterminal.com OA breakdown